

Make Your NIC Do Some Work

This applies only if your network adapter has an onboard processor: you can find out from the spec sheet whether or not it does. If it does, it has been designed to offload network processing computations from the CPU. This hack can reduce system slowdown during high-speed data transfers.

Navigate to:

HLM\System\CurrentControlSet\Services\Tcpip\Parameters

Create a new DWORD value called `DisableTaskOffload` and set it to 0 to enable the NIC's processor. Of course, if the key exists and is set to 1, reset it to 0.

A restart is required for the change to take effect.

Take Control Of Your Modem

You've probably experienced this if you're on dial-up: if remote connections are enabled, your computer initiates an Internet connection—at startup or when an application demands it—and you find your modem dialling all on its own. Here's how to disable that behaviour.

Navigate to:

HLM\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Ole

Create a new String value (or modify the existing value) called `EnableRemoteConnect`. Set it to N to disable your modem stealing control. Of course, you can always set it to Y if bad things happen after you do this.

A restart is required for the change to take effect.

Change The Priority Of The Print Spooler

The “priority” of a task is the degree of urgency that the task presents to the processor—requests from a task with higher priority are served earlier. Now, the default setting for the Print Spooler is to